

Zander Martineau

Product Engineer

Front-end depth • Design systems • AI-assisted development • London, UK

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ABOUT ME

Product engineer with 18+ years building for the web – front-end at my core, comfortable across the full stack. I focus on shipping the right thing: understanding the user, shaping the product, and owning the outcome, not just the ticket. My work spans fintech, health, music, and energy trading, usually on complex, data-heavy applications where design systems and interface quality have outsized impact.

At Dare I was Staff Engineer and web team lead on mission-critical ETRM software. I led a monolith-to-micro-frontend migration, built the component library that held it together, and built a new AI product surface for traders: an MCP-backed LLM chat for querying live trade data in natural language. When the chat proved too slow for the tempo traders work at, I shelved it and channelled the effort into MCP-driven generative UI, which is where the lasting value landed. That's the pattern I bring to AI: build it seriously, judge it on real use, keep what works.

I'm a firm believer in AI-assisted development. A deep understanding of the web platform means I can direct and orchestrate AI agents well – accelerating the right things without sacrificing quality. The engineers who get the most from these tools know when to lean in and when to pull back; throwing too many concerns at an agent at once is a fast path to technical debt.

I care about long-term impact on a team: writing maintainable code, raising standards, and helping the people around me do their best work.

HIGHLIGHTS

- **AI-assisted development** – Daily driver of agentic coding tools (Claude Code, Codex, Cursor, Amp, OpenCode); hands-on with MCP servers, skills / SKILL.md workflows, and orchestrating agents on real projects.
- **Design systems & component libraries** – Built design systems at Dare, Curve, and FairFX/Equals, plus ZUI as an open-source multi-framework token library. Storybook, shadcn/ui, MUI, Chakra, Mantine; visual regression with Percy & Chromatic.

- **React ecosystem** – React, Next.js, TanStack, Remix, Astro, Vite; server-rendered and single-page architectures.
- **Full-stack & APIs** – Node.js with Hono, Express, Fastify; serverless and edge on Cloudflare Workers and Vercel; Drizzle ORM, Neon Postgres.
- **Real-time & messaging** – WebSockets and NATS / JetStream for event-driven, real-time data applications.
- **Desktop & micro-frontends** – Electron apps; micro-frontend architectures with single-spa and RSBUILD.
- **TypeScript & JavaScript** – Deep TypeScript across OO and functional styles; vanilla JS from ES5 to modern ESNEXT.
- **Styling** – Modern CSS, Tailwind, CSS-in-JS (Styled Components, Emotion, Stitches), Sass.
- **Testing & CI/CD** – Vitest, Jest, Cypress, Playwright; GitHub Actions, GitLab CI, CircleCI. Cloud across AWS, GCP, Vercel, Cloudflare, Netlify.
- **GraphQL & data fetching** – Apollo, TanStack Query, Hasura.

SIDE PROJECTS

I build constantly to push the web platform and pressure-test ideas, lately much of it while evaluating AI coding agents on real work. Mostly a Cloudflare + Hono + TanStack + Drizzle + Neon stack. Full list at zander.wtf/projects and github.com/mrmartineau.

- **ZUI** zui.zander.wtf – CSS-first, multi-framework component and design-token library (React, Astro, Solid, Svelte, Vue), no build step required. Published to npm as @mrmartineau/zui.
- **Otter** otter.zander.wtf – Self-hosted, privacy-first bookmark manager and media tracker. Raycast extension, iOS app, and its own MCP server for agent access.
- **Simmer** simmer.zander.wtf – Recipe manager that parses recipes from around the web into structured, searchable data using AI.
- **Reps** reps.zander.wtf – Daily in-browser JavaScript coding puzzle, one function a day.
- **Lab** lab.zander.wtf – A running set of platform experiments: a draggable 24-hour learning clock (SVG), fully keyboard-driven cursorless navigation (a11y), a p5.js kids' drawing app, and an interactive data-transformation trainer.
- **Open-source packages & tooling** @mrmartineau – npm packages including **strifx** (clsx for strings), **xtractr** (page-to-markdown extractor) and **url-merge**, plus a TypeScript package template with a built-in SKILL.md for AI-assisted dev, a Zed editor extension (Rust/LSP), and a set of Raycast extensions.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Dare International

January 2024–July 2026 / dare.global / Energy Trading

Staff Software Engineer

Staff Engineer and web team lead on Dare's core ETRM (Energy Trading and Risk Management) platform – a complex, real-time system traders depend on daily, built on React, WebSockets, and NATS messaging.

- Built a new **AI product surface for traders** shipped as its own micro frontend. It paired an MCP-backed LLM chat for querying live trade data in natural language with generative UI for displaying and interacting with trades. The chat worked end-to-end but proved too slow for traders' tempo, so I shelved it and pivoted the effort into the MCP-driven generative UI, which fed directly into later work.
- Led a **consolidated real-time trade feed** that replaced watching each exchange in its own app. Normalised heterogeneous feeds (multicast and Google Pub/Sub) into one canonical model over NATS / JetStream, added capabilities the native tickers lacked (e.g. historical replay), and rolled it out desk by desk starting with the CEO's. It won on adoption against the exchanges' own tools.
- Built the company's **component library** from the ground up on Tailwind and shadcn/ui, replacing four coexisting styling systems (Sass, Ant Design, MUI, styled-components). Included trading-specific components and layouts, and became the consistency backbone across every micro frontend.
- Led the **micro-frontend migration** of the 8-year-old monolithic frontend (RSBuild), shrinking deployment blast radius from the whole app to a single section and letting the team ship faster and more safely.
- Led development on the **Electron desktop application** and championed stronger testing (Vitest, Playwright) and CI/CD across the team.

TECH: React, micro-frontends with RSBuild, Electron, TypeScript, Tailwind, shadcn/ui, Vitest, Playwright end-to-end tests, WebSockets, NATS, CI/CD with GitHub Actions

Fathom

January 2023–September 2023 / fathom.com / Digital Agency

Product Engineer (Contract)

Delivered front-end across concurrent client projects: a crypto exchange platform (Tradeblock), investment-banking apps (Commerzbank, Clearwater Analytics), and a full React rebrand (Cappitech) – each requiring fast ramp-up on an existing codebase.

TECH: React, Next.js, Vite, TypeScript, Node.js services, OpenAPI schemas, MUI, Storybook, Vitest, Cypress & Playwright, CI/CD with GitLab & GitHub

Utopia Music

June 2022–November 2022 / utopiamusic.com / Music industry services

Senior Front-End Engineer (Contract)

Part of a contractor team rebuilding Rostr 2.0 ("the IMDB for music") in Remix, bringing server-side rendering and better data-loading than the previous version.

TECH: React, Remix, TypeScript, Node.js services, MongoDB, Chakra UI, Storybook, Cypress, CI/CD with GitLab

Babylon Health

November 2021–June 2022 / babylonhealth.com / Digital-first healthcare

Senior Front-End Engineer (Contract)

Built two core internal platforms – a clinician/patient management tool and a consultation interface used by NHS GPs – and led their migration to a micro-frontend architecture with single-spa.

TECH: React, TypeScript, GraphQL, Apollo, Micro-frontends (single-spa), Formik, MUI, Storybook, Cypress, CI/CD with GitHub Actions & CircleCI

Digital Futures

February 2021–November 2021 / digitalfutures.com / Technology services and training startup

LEAD Front-End Engineer (Contract)

Led a small team to ship two full applications in nine months on a GraphQL/Hasura + Firebase backend with a React front-end, owning architectural decisions across the stack.

TECH: React, TypeScript, GraphQL, Hasura, Firebase, Vite, React Query, React Router, Formik, Theme UI, Radix UI, Nivo charts, Storybook, Cypress, CI/CD with GitHub Actions

Heights

October 2020–February 2021 / yourheights.com / Braincare startup

Senior Front-End Engineer (Contract)

Built a bespoke component library and migrated the platform from Shopify to Gatsby in seven weeks, delivering the relaunch ahead of a successful crowdfunding round.

TECH: React, TypeScript, Gatsby, GraphQL, React Query, Storybook, Contentful, CI/CD with CircleCI

EARLIER ROLES

Various Short-Term Contracts 2020 – fintech, local government, and e-commerce work across Club View, Hackney City Council (via Digi2al), and doTERRA (via WQA).

Curve – Senior Front-end Engineer (Contract) 2019–2020 / curve.com / Fintech startup – built the first version of Curve's web design system and a web component for their Samsung Pay Card integration.

FairFX / Equals – Senior Front-end Engineer (Contract) 2018–2019 – designed and built the "Fuji" design system, adopted across every web app including React Native.

Nimbletank – Front-end Tech Lead 2017–2018 – led and grew the web platform team across complex React SPA/SSR apps; established a rigorous code-review process.

TMW Unlimited – Creative Technology Lead 2012–2017 – progressed from Creative Technologist to lead; delivered global brand sites (incl. barilla.com), games, and prototypes as scrum master and lead dev.

Neverbland – Lead Front-end Developer & Designer 2010–2012 – led front-end engineering and design across web projects with a modern, standards-based approach.

Early career 2002–2010 – Lead Front-end Developer/Designer at Parker Fox, freelance web design/dev, and Assistant Cameraman on UK film & TV – a mix of technical, creative, and production work.